

FEMA National Watch Center

Daily Operations Briefing

Tuesday, September 8, 2026

8:30 a.m. ET



FEMA

National Current Operations / Monitoring

New Significant Incidents / Ongoing Operations

- Hurricane Lowell (CAT-2) – Hawaii

Hazard Monitoring

- Excessive Rainfall / Severe Thunderstorms – Iowa to the Upper Midwest
- Elevated Fire Weather – Northern Plains
- Tropical Activity:
 - Eastern and Central Pacific:
 - Hurricane Lowell (CAT-2)
 - Tropical Storm Marie
 - Disturbance 1: High (70%)
 - Disturbance 2: Low (20%)

Disaster Declaration Activity

- No new declaration activity

Event Monitoring

- No new significant events



FEMA

Hurricane Lowell (CAT-2) – Hawaii

Situation: The core of Lowell is forecast to pass near or just west of Ni'ihau today. Damaging hurricane conditions are ongoing across Kaua'i County, and tropical storm conditions are affecting the island of O'ahu. The highest winds are expected atop mountains and on windward and leeward slopes. Large damaging waves will impact exposed portions of the coastline, producing dangerous coastal flooding and inundation of low-lying areas through early Tuesday. Hurricane Warnings remain in effect. Periods of heavy rainfall associated with Lowell will increase in coverage over the Hawaiian Islands through Wednesday. This may produce significant flash flooding and mudslides, especially across Kaua'i County and portions of the Big Island. (FEMA HLT Advisory #49, as of 5:40 a.m. ET, Sep 8)

Hazards Affecting Land: (FEMA HLT Advisory #49, as of 5:40 p.m. ET, Sep 8)

Wind:

- Hurricane conditions in Kaua'i County have begun, with tropical storm conditions affecting the island of O'ahu. Wind speeds atop and on the windward and leeward sides of hills and mountains may be up to 30 percent stronger than near-surface winds. Hurricane-force winds extend outward up to 70 miles from center, and tropical-storm-force winds extend outward up to 175 miles.

Rainfall:

- Lowell is expected to bring 4-8 inches of additional rain to Kaua'i, with maximum storm totals up to 24 inches possible. The Big Island could receive an additional 3-8 inches of rainfall, with isolated storm totals up to 12 inches possible. O'ahu, and Maui counties could receive 2-5 inches, with isolated totals of 10 inches. Significant flash flooding and mudslides may occur, especially across Kaua'i County and portions of the Big Island.

Storm Surge:

- Storm surge combined with the tide may flood normally dry coastal areas as water moves inland from the shoreline. If peak surge occurs at high tide, water levels could reach 2-4 feet in Kaua'i county, with the highest expected values along the south coast of Kaua'i, and Ni'ihau. Water levels could reach up to 1 foot on O'ahu.

Surf:

- Swells from Lowell are likely to cause life-threatening surf and rip current conditions across many of the Hawaiian Islands during the next several days.

Lifeline Impacts: (FEMA R9 Update #12, as of 1:01 a.m. ET, Sep 8)

Safety & Security: The City and County of Honolulu will close all non-essential City offices, facilities, programs, and services

- Voluntary evacuations have been issued for residents on Kauai's south and west shores
- State/county government offices and public schools closed .
- *Food, Hydration, Shelter*: 5 shelters with 155 occupants in Kauai County

Energy: Minimal power outages reported throughout the islands (*Eagle-I*, as of 6:30 a.m. ET, Sep 08)

- Power outages: Hawaii 59k (12%) customers without power
 - Kaua'i County: 33k (93%) customers without power
 - Honolulu County: 25k (8%) customers without power

Transportation: Limited road, airport, and seaport closures

- Road Closures: Numerous roads remain closed due to high water and washouts
- Sea Ports:
 - Kaua'i: Condition ZULU – All ports are closed
 - Honolulu: Condition WHISKEY – Proceed with caution
 - O'ahu: Condition YANKEE – Ports are restricted
- Airports: Lihue Airport closed until Wednesday morning

State / Local Response: (FEMA R9 DSAR, as of 12:01 p.m. ET, Sep 7)

- HI SEOC at [Full](#) Activation (TC Lowell)
- Governor issued an Emergency Proclamation relating to September 2026 Tropical Cyclones

FEMA / Federal Response: (FEMA R9 DSAR, as of 12:01 p.m. ET, Sep 7)

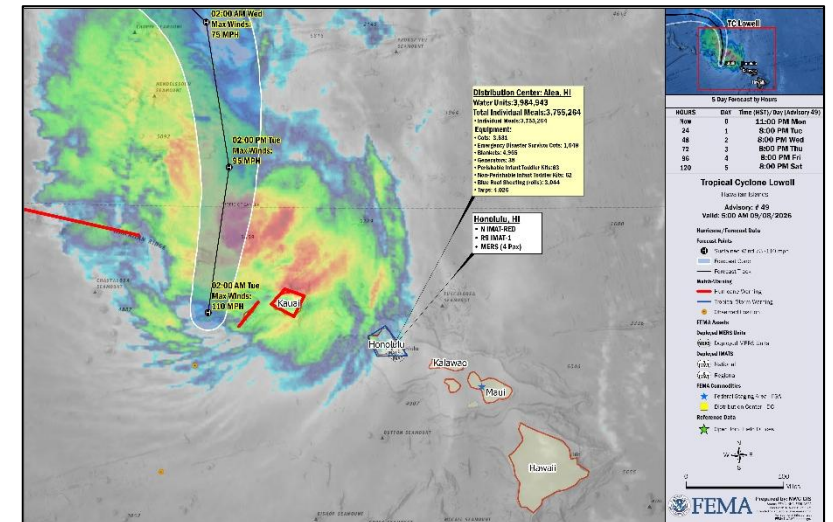
FEMA Region 9:

- RWC at Enhanced Watch (TC Lowell); RRCC is Rostered, will activate at 12:00 p.m. ET, Sep 8
- FIT LNO Deployed to HI SEOC
- R-IMAT-1 Deployed to HI (DR-4909-HI/EM-3652-HI)

HQ:

- NWC is Monitoring; NRCC at Steady State (Blue Team is Rostered)
- N-IMAT Red Deployed to Honolulu, HI
- Bothell MERS Deployed to Honolulu, HI
- SMT Hawaii and Tracy on Alert

Other Federal Agencies: DoW and ESFs 3, 8, 11, and 12 are Deployed

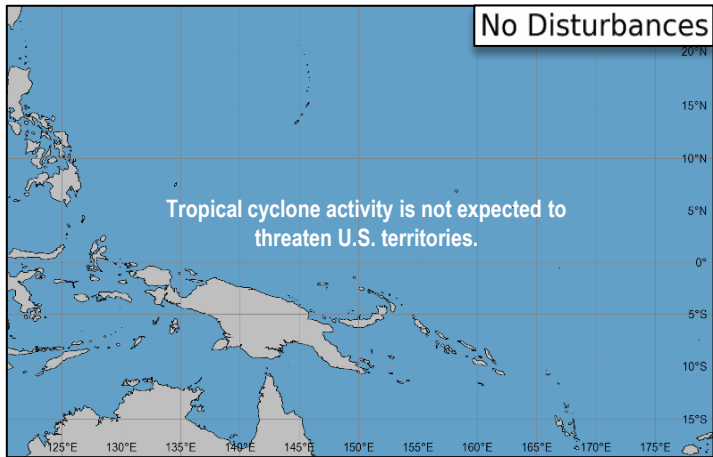


The NWC will continue to monitor in coordination with FEMA Region 9. Reporting will continue twice daily in the FEMA National Situation Report (3:00 a.m. / 5:00 p.m. ET) and the FEMA Daily Operations Briefing (8:30 a.m. ET).

National Watch Center

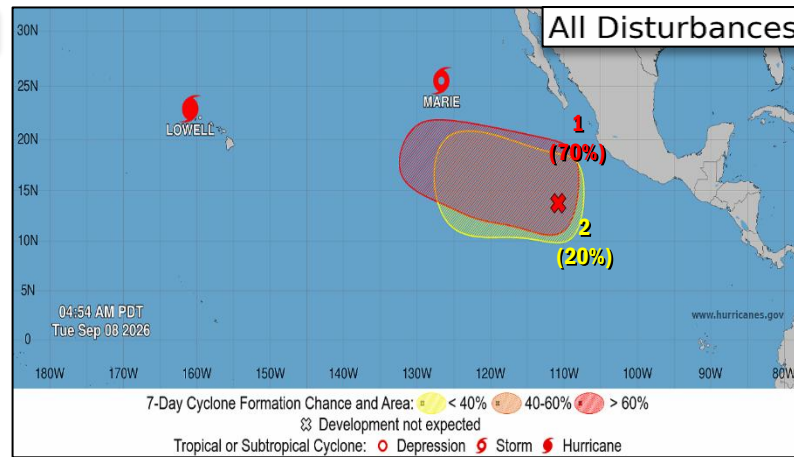
Tropical Outlook

Western Pacific



- Tropical cyclone activity is not expected to threaten U.S. territories.

Eastern and Central Pacific



Hurricane Lowell (CAT-2): (*Advisory #49A, as of 5:00 a.m. ET*)

- See next slide

Tropical Storm Marie: (*Advisory #29, as of 5:00 a.m. ET*)

- See next slide

Disturbance 1: (*as of 5:00 a.m. ET*)

- Offshore of southwestern Mexico
- Moving WNW at 10-15 mph
- Gradual development is **likely**; a tropical depression could form during the middle or latter portions of the week
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (20%); 7-day: Medium (70%)

Disturbance 2: (*as of 5:00 a.m. ET*)

- Well south of the southern tip of Baja, Mexico
- Moving WNW at 10-15 mph
- Gradual development is possible
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (0%); 7-day: Low (20%)

Atlantic



- Tropical cyclone activity is not expected during the next 7 days.



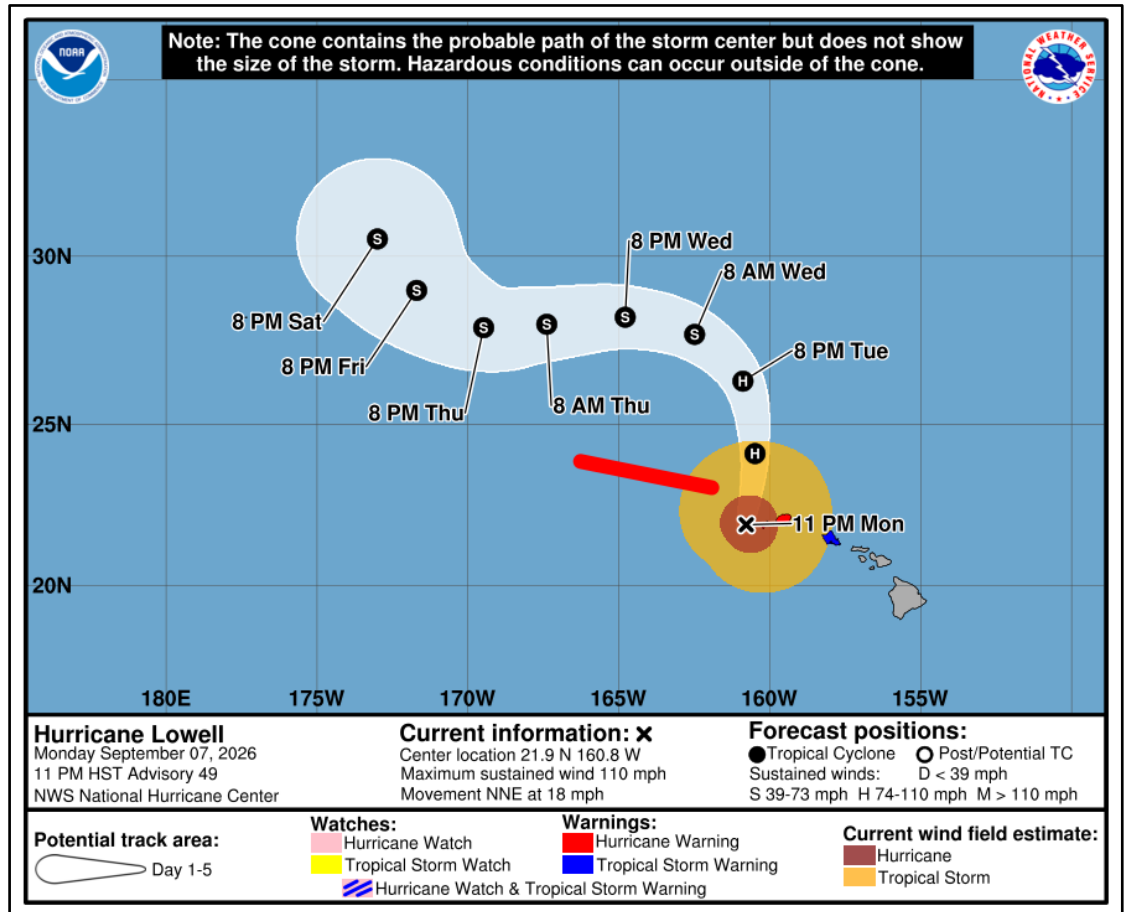
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Hurricane Lowell (CAT-2) – Central Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #49A, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 110 miles NW of Lihue, HI
- Moving N at 18 mph
- Maximum sustained winds of 105 mph
- Hurricane-force-winds extend outward up to 70 miles from center; tropical-storm-force winds extend outward up to 195 miles from center
- Lowell is forecast to remain a powerful hurricane as it passes near the Hawaiian Islands
- Gradual weakening is expected over the next few days



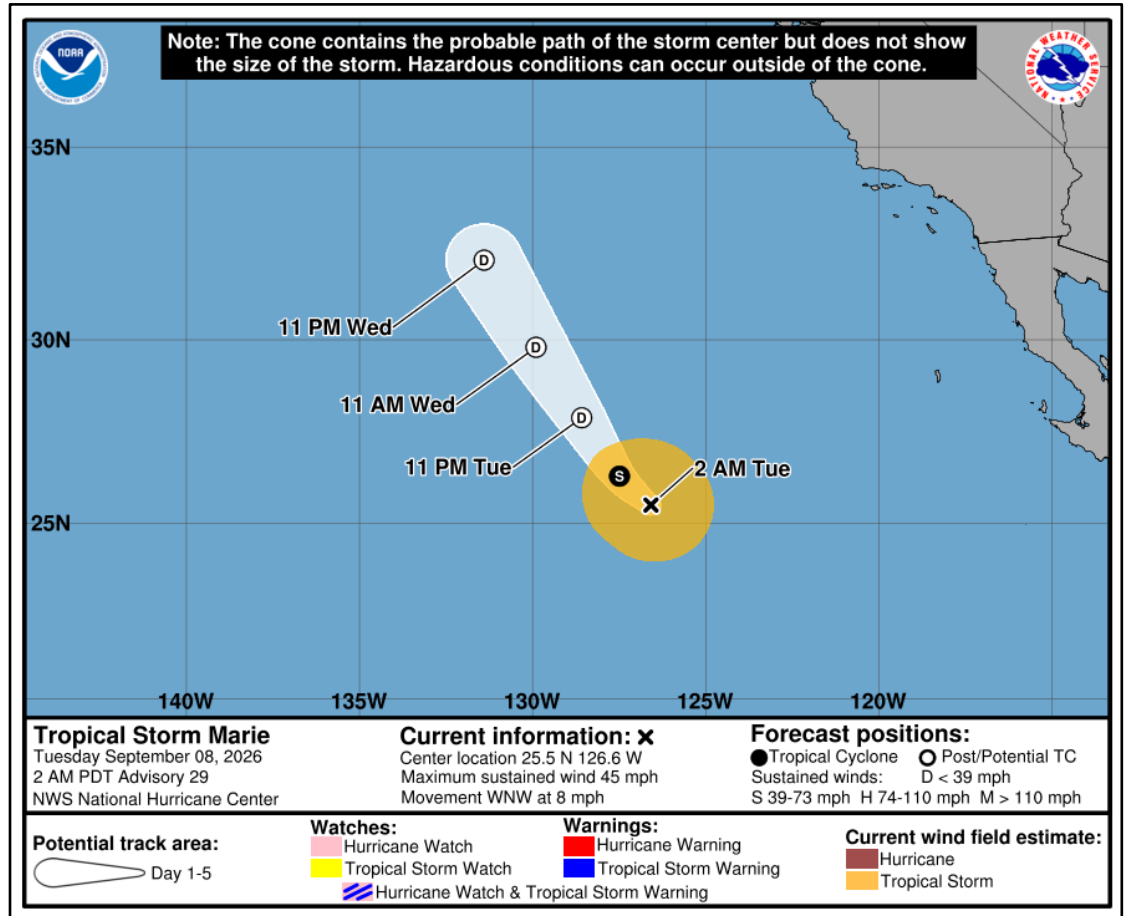
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Tropical Storm Marie – Eastern Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #29, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

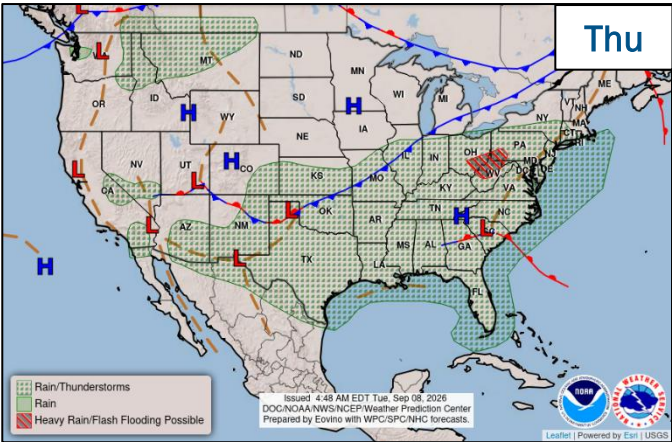
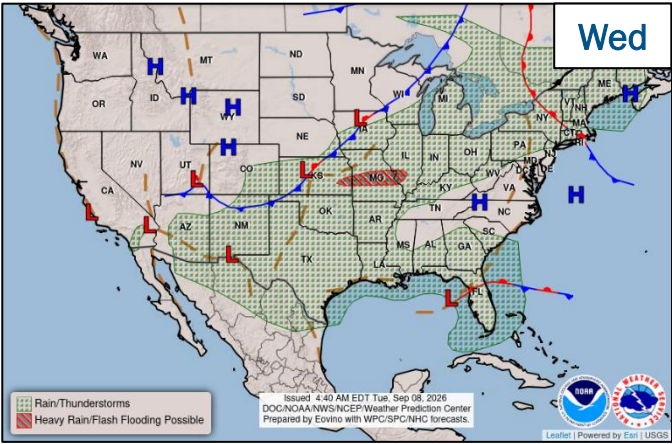
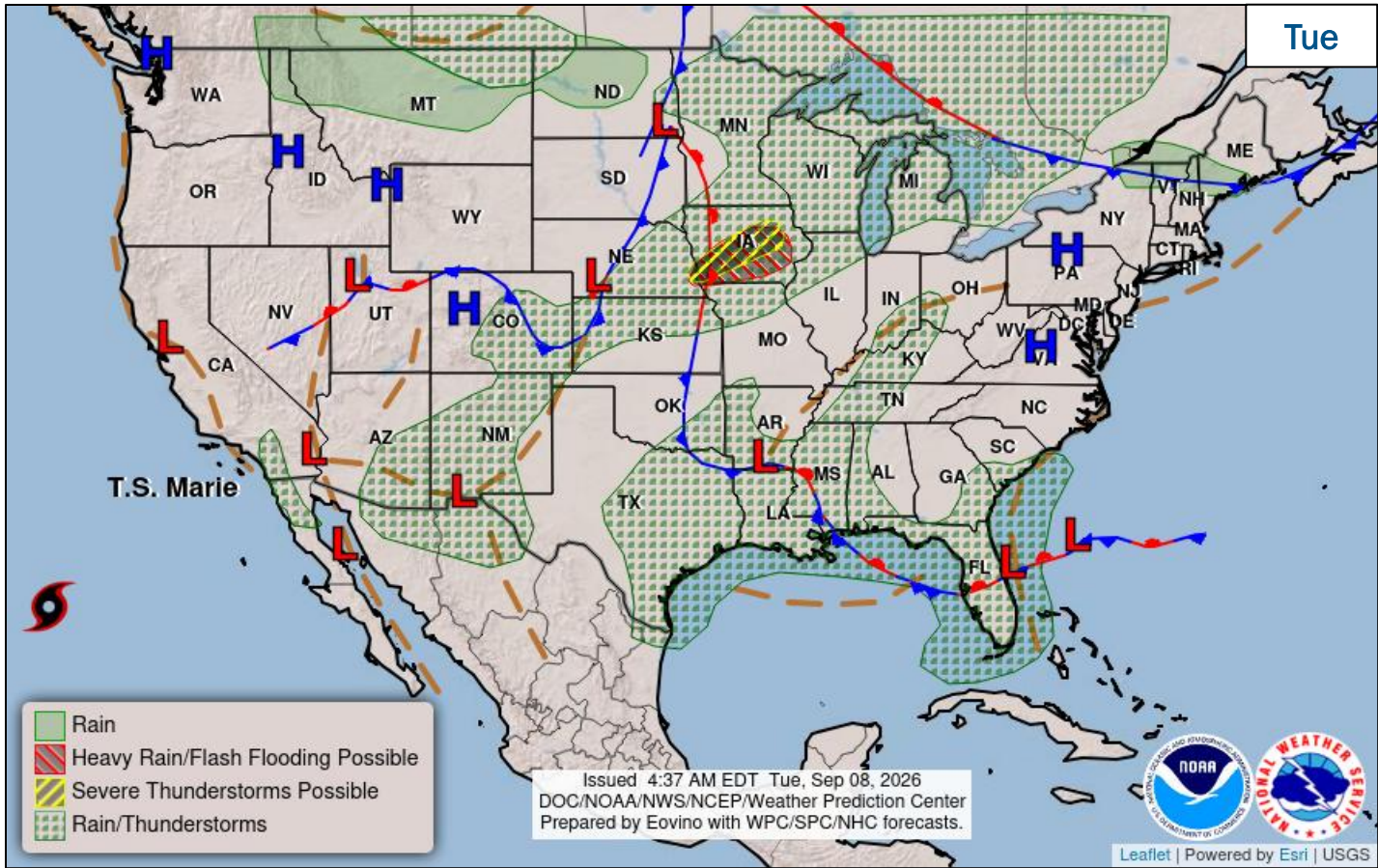
- Located **760** miles SW of San Diego, CA
- Moving WNW at 8 mph
- Maximum sustained winds of **45** mph
- Tropical-storm-force winds extend up to **140** miles from center
- Steady weakening is expected to continue for the next couple days
- Marie is forecast to become a post-tropical remnant low **later today or** on Wednesday



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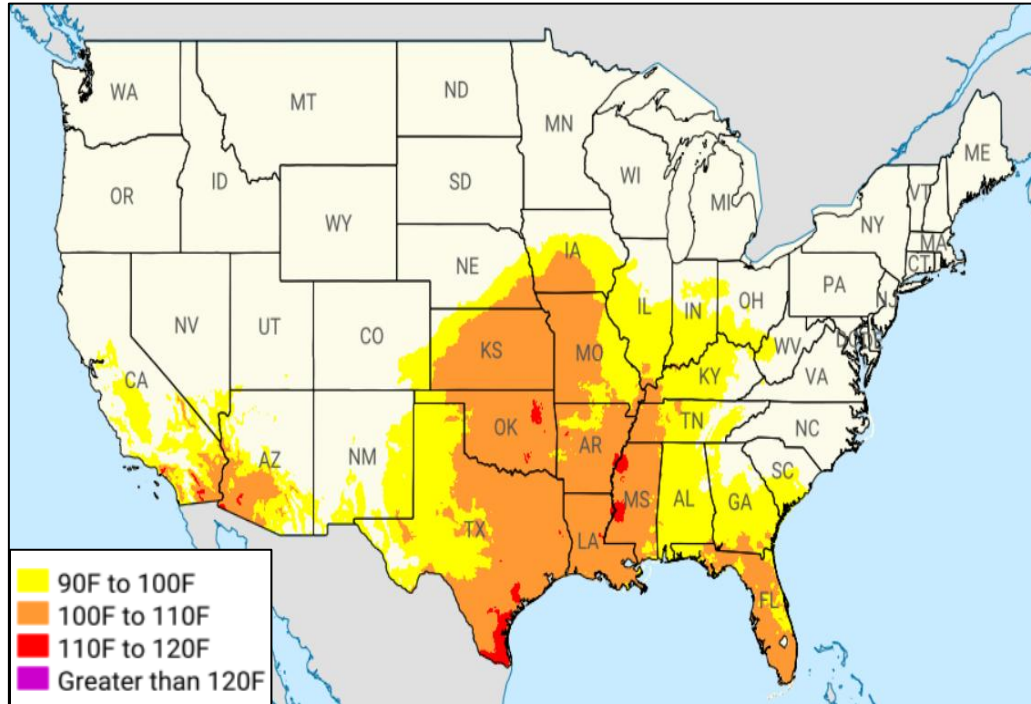
National Watch Center

National Weather Forecast

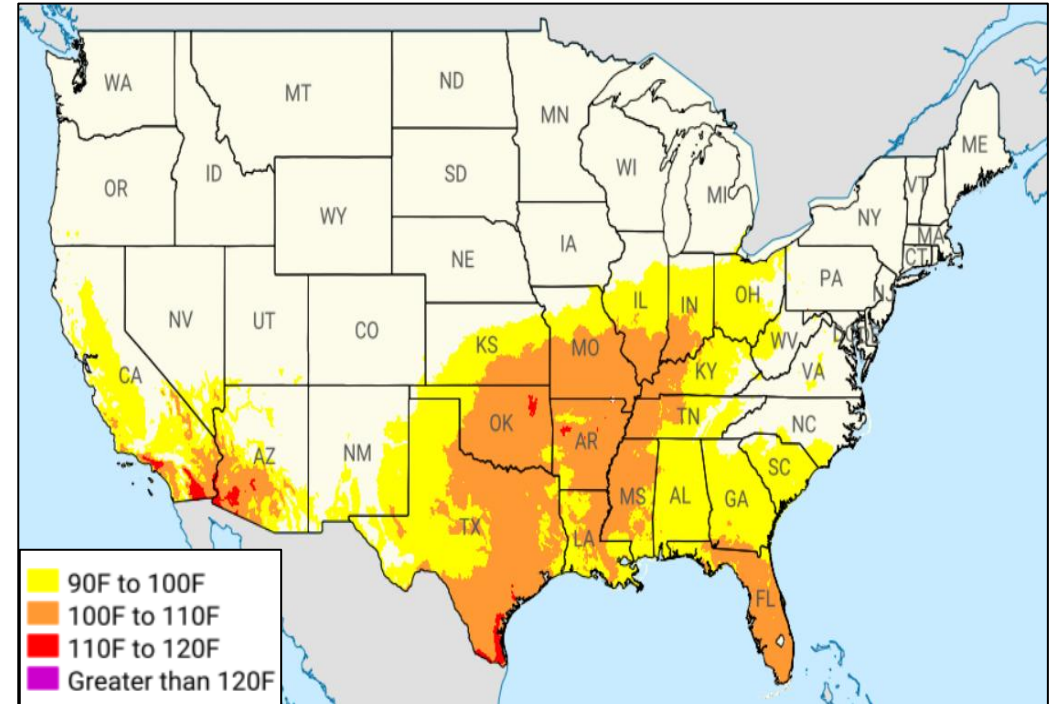


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Heat Risk



Day 1



Day 2

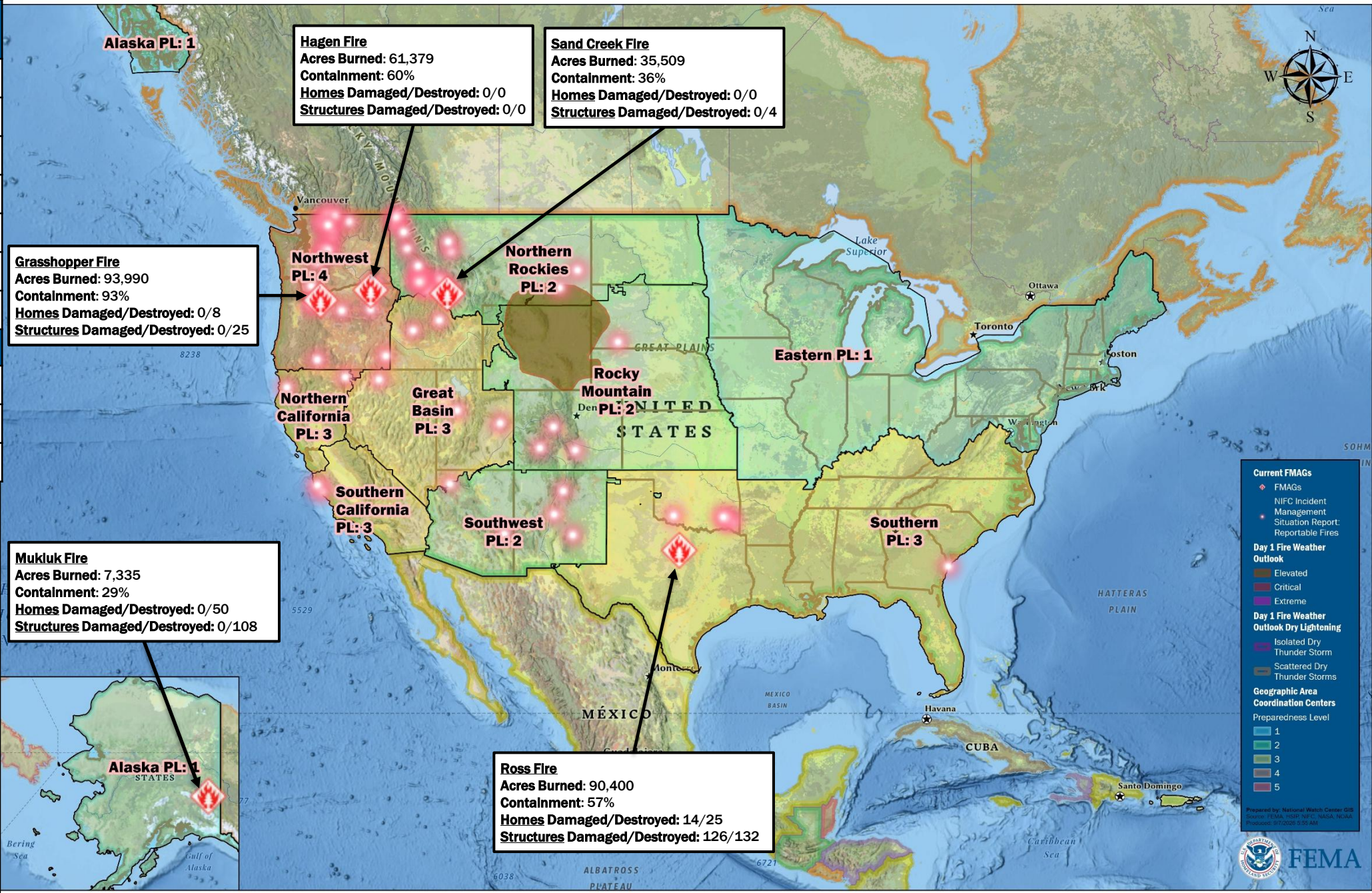


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National Fire Activity – September 8, 2026

INITIAL ATTACK ACTIVITY (24-hour period)	Light (66 fires)
New Large Fires	0
Large Fires Contained	1
Uncontained Large Fires	66
Year-to-Date Acres Burned	8,303,398
Total Responders	15,855
Type 1 IMTs Deployed	0
Complex IMTs Deployed	16
FMAGS	Total
2026 (FYTD)	61
2025	75
3 Year Average	53

Preparedness Levels:	
PL 1	Minimal fire activity; many resources available
PL 2	Large wildland fires burning throughout country; resources mobilized from other areas
PL 3	Wildfire activity ongoing throughout 25% of country; National Interagency Coordination Center (NICC) sets priorities, allocates resources, and mobilizes assets at national level
PL 4	High levels of fire activity and areas are competing for firefighting resources; 60% of the nation's wildland firefighting resources committed
PL 5	Extremely high levels of fire activity; 80% of nation's firefighting resources committed



Current FMAGS

- FMAGS
- NIFC Incident Management Situation Report Reportable Fires

Day 1 Fire Weather Outlook

- Elevated
- Critical
- Extreme

Day 1 Fire Weather Outlook Dry Lightning

- Isolated Dry Thunder Storm
- Scattered Dry Thunder Storms

Geographic Area Coordination Centers

Preparedness Level

- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5



FEMA Common Operating Picture

National Watch Center

Incident Workforce

18,930
Assigned a Disaster Title

6,276 / 33%
Deployed

6,081 / 32%
Available to Deploy for 30 Days

6,573 / 35%
Remaining

Surge Capacity Force
7,702 / 0 / 770
Rostered / Deployed /
Est. Available to Deploy for 30 Days

Tuesday
September 8, 2026
8:30 a.m. ET

National Readiness

National Watch Center



NRCC



N-IMAT Red



N-IMAT White



N-IMAT Blue



N-IMAT Gold



N-IMAT HS



National Notes

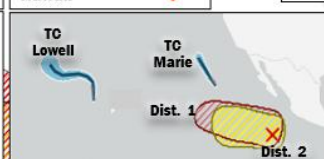
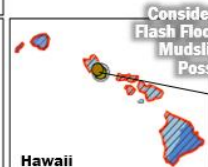
National Watch:
• NWC: Staffing

NRCC:
• Rostered

National IMATs:
• N-IMAT Red: Deployed to HI
(TC Lowell)
• N-IMAT White: Staffing
• N-IMAT Blue: Staffing

REGIONAL BREAKDOWN

	JFO	DR	EM	JRO
R1	0	1	0	0
R2	0	0	0	2
R3	0	2	0	0
R4	4	14	0	1
R5	0	3	0	0
R6	4	7	3	3
R7	0	9	0	0
R8	1	9	0	0
R9	0	6	6	0
R10	4	7	1	0



Camp Murray, WA
EM-3650-WA
• R10 IMAT

Small Stream
Flooding Poss.

Indianapolis, IN
DR-4933-IN
EM-3651-IN
• R5 IMAT

Charleston, WV
DR-4932-WV
• R3 IMAT

South Carolina
DR-4829-SC
DR-4835-SC
DR-4858-SC
DR-4908-SC
Closing 9/18

Honolulu, HI
DR-4909-HI &
EM-3652-HI
• R9 IMAT-1
• N IMAT-RED
• MERS

Considerable
Flash Flooding &
Mudslides
Poss.

Severe Wx:
Slight Risk

Iso. Flash &
Urban
Flooding

Elevated Fire Wx

Major - Extreme
Heat Risk

Major - Extreme
Heat Risk

FEMA Headquarters

Regional Offices

Regional IMAT

Pre-Positioned Site

Distribution Center

Recovery Support Function Activations

Open Joint Field Offices

Joint Recovery Office

Direct Housing Missions

Large Fires

State Activation Levels

Full

Partial

Monitoring

Normal

Regional Readiness

Watch RRCC IMAT

Region 1



Region 2



Region 3



Region 4



Region 5



Region 6



Region 7



Region 8



Region 9



Region 10



Regional Notes

Watches/RRCCs:
• R2 Watch: Equipment
• R5 Watch: Staffing
• R9 Watch: Tropical Activity

State EOCs:
• FL/MS: Previous Incidents
• AK/CO/ID/NV/OK/UT/WA: Wildfires
• IL/KY/TN/TX/WV: Severe Weather
• MP: TC Bavi/ Saudel
• PR/VA: Drought
• HI: TC Lowell
• IN: Support for 4933-DR-IN
• NH: Primary Elections

IMATs:
• R1: Staffing
• R3: 4932-EM-WV
• R4-1/2: Staffing
• R5: 3651-EM-IN
• R7: Reconstituting (FMC 9/8)
• R9-1: 4909-DR-HI/3652-EM-HI
• R9-2: 4910-DR-MP
• R10: 3650-EM-WA

Legend

- Fully Mission Capable
- Partially Mission Capable
- Requires Augmentation
- Deployed/Activated

Commodities & Equipment

	CONUS	Caribbean	Hawaii	Guam
Water				
Meals				
Generators				

SMT

Operational	11/11
Requires Augmentation	3/11
Deployed	0/11

MERS Det.

30/36 Operational	
Maynard	4/6
Frederick	6/6
Thomasville	6/6
Denton	6/6
Denver	4/6
Bothell	4/6

US&R

Task Forces	
Assigned	28
Non-FEMA Deployed	1
FEMA-Deployed	0
Not Mission Capable	0
Available	27
FEMA Support Staff	11/21

FCO

Assigned	38
Not Mission Capable	1
Deployed	32 (22 FCOR)
Available	5

Joint Preliminary Damage Assessments

Region	State / Location	Event	IA	Number of Counties		Start – End
			PA	Requested	Complete	
R3	WV	Severe Storms Aug 15-18	IA	3	0	8/31 – TBD
			PA	0	0	N/A
R7	KS	Severe Storms Aug 18-19	IA	0	0	N/A
			PA	1	0	9/8 – TBD



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National Watch Center

Declaration Requests in Process – 9

State / Tribe / Territory – Incident Description	Type	IA	PA	HM	Requested
NH – Severe Storm and Flash Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Jul 8
IN – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Aug 6
GU – Super Typhoon Bavi	DR	X	X	X	Aug 11
MN – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Aug 20
UT – Cottonwood Fire, Flooding, and Mudslides	DR		X	X	Aug 22
WI – Severe Storms and Tornado	DR	X	X	X	Aug 26
WV – Severe Storm, Flooding, Landslides, and Mudslides – Appeal	DR	X		X	Aug 31
OH – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, Flooding, and Landslides	DR	X			Sep 2
OK – Severe Storms and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 2



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Helping people before, during, and after disasters.



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